

Memory loss

Kingston Technology recalls some DataTraveler models after a security flaw is discovered

New Opera CEO

Lars Boilesen succeeds Jon Von Tetzchner as CEO of Opera

In the same manner, suspicious applications can also be blocked.

There's even remotely checking on other installations on the network. With its non-flashy user interface and pretty low system resource needs, it's a solution for SoHos running slightly older hardware. The pricing is pretty impressive as well.

Price: Rs. 1,250 (single user – 1 year)

Rs. 1,600 (three user – 1 year)

F-Secure Internet Security 2010

F-Secure's Internet Security 2010's installation starts with a bang. Once the automated installer reboots the PC, the suite starts updating while you're shown a display to set up all the parental controls. Speaking of which, there is a very good level of settings made available. For example, you can choose how many hours in a day and the period during which browsing is allowed. You can choose to restrict or allow browsing on weekends and also set a period for that. Finally, a list of categories of sites is displayed to choose from. Simply tick mark the category of sites to be allowed.

Just when you thought the user interfaces of these suites couldn't get any classier, F-Secure does one better. Just like its streamlined installation procedure, the user interface has a really classy look with just three buttons – Status, Tasks and Statistics.

7/10	
Features.....	5.5
Performance	7
Ease of use.....	8
Value for money.....	7

Other than that, F-Secure doesn't look like it does a lot more. Data identity and protection are out of the question and there is none of the online storage services allowed. The other usual components are present. With the fancy interface comes more memory consumption. F-Secure uses close to 35MB of memory on idle and around 60 MB during scans.

Price: Rs. 1,400 (single user – 1 year)

Rs. 2,700 (three user – 1 year)

Conclusion

It's difficult to conclude a comparison review of security suites. Updates and their range of detection really govern the performance of a suite. It's something that changes every couple of days when

a new virus or a new virus definition is released.

The suites from F-Secure, Trend Micro and Symantec were some of the best as far as ease of use were concerned. A security suite which uses complicated terms and menus isn't a great idea with the slightly non-geeky crowd. These suites are suitable for home users.

It was also good to see suites using less than 100MB of RAM. CPU utilisation was a little higher in the case of AVG Internet Security. Trend Micro was very efficient as well. When compared with the others, F-Secure lacked in features. eScan did too but it had some nice unique features such as the remote support.

No matter what anti-virus suite you use, you're never absolutely free from vulnerabilities. It's only a matter of time before one of these are exploited. An unpatched operating system, an instant messenger or email client are just some of these loopholes. Moving viruses detection techniques and databases to the cloud allows for real time detection of threats. It's a step in the right direction but getting quick fixes is a different story altogether. That's left to the developers to ensure there isn't another one of those chaotic scenes where PCs all across the globe are infected by a computer virus epidemic. **d**



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HOW WE TESTED

The security suites were installed on a Windows 7 system running a Pentium 4 3 GHz processor and 1 GB of memory. We did this to try and simulate what the majority of users would be running in terms of hardware, as well as check compatibility with the latest platform.

The test was primarily focussed on features. Performance is something that's very difficult to gauge

no matter how large a virus set you use. With the number of viruses that come out every day, performance ratings for a security suite could be invalid the very next day.

We were looking for a light security suite. A security suite that slows down the system to a standstill is of no use at all. We looked for suites that would be simple to use without throwing up all kinds of technical terms

to confuse a user. The comparison review is specifically meant for home users and also some small offices.

Every security suite needed the prerequisite feature set – it had to have an antivirus, a firewall and preferably spam filtering and other similar features were an added bonus. We tried out all these features to determine how useful they were.